

The digestive system

An average person eats about 20 tons of food in a lifetime. The digestive system transforms this mountain of meals into substances that the body can use. The system breaks food down into simple nutrients that supply energy to body cells and provide the chemicals needed to make the body grow, maintain, and repair itself.



FRIENDLY BACTERIA

Inside the intestines are trillions of "friendly" bacteria, such as *Lactobacillus fermentum*. They release extra nutrients from food for the body to use.